



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Who was the first person to climb Mt. Everest?



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about sports and leisure time.
- I can describe feelings, things and events.
- I can report facts about events and actions.

Ask your partner:

- What's the most difficult hike or climb you've ever done?
- What types of things do you do that you consider adventurous?

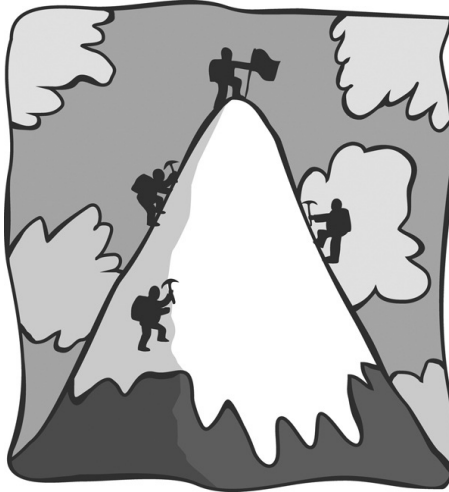




Let's Explore!

This is my **Everest***!

* If something is an "Everest", it is a huge challenge.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

For most of modern history, Mount Everest was said to be unclimbable. At 8,848 meters, it was thought to be too high, dangerous, and terrifying to climb. It was first suggested to be possible in 1885 in a book entitled *Above the Snow Line*. The author, Clinton Thomas Dent, was convinced that it could be achieved. The feat wouldn't be successfully accomplished, however, for another 50-plus years.

After several failed expeditions, it was a New Zealander, Edmund Hillary, and a Nepali sherpa, Tenzing Norgay, who were credited with first reaching the peak.

For many years, Hillary and Norgay were reported to have summited together, but it was later confirmed that the New Zealander had been the first to set foot at the top.

Mountain climbing used to be an activity only done by explorers like Hillary and Norgay, but over time it has become a mainstream sport. That being said, this challenging sport is certainly not for the timid or careless. To be a successful mountaineer, a person needs to be patient. It is very easy to become frustrated if progress is slow or weather conditions force a change of plan.

Because it is such a frustrating activity, climbers must be resourceful. They must use their brains as well as their bodies to reach the top of the mountain. Lastly, alpinists must be well-equipped with the appropriate gear, including ropes and pitons.

Each mountain ascent presents new challenges and a climber has to be prepared for different mountain conditions and environmental factors. If the mountain is steep and icy, climbers have to take extra precaution. They must plan their climbs well and calculate each step. Mountain climbing, like most exciting sports, can be dangerous. But for thrill-seekers, the rush of summiting outweighs the fear.





Let's Practice!

Mount Everest is said to be a terrifying mountain to climb.

Instructions: Complete the sentences below by choosing from the given options. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

Exciting / convinced / challenging / frustrating / frustrated / Failed

1. Climbing is a _____ activity not suitable for timid people.
2. It's easy to become _____ if weather conditions force a change of plans.
3. A few people were _____ that climbing Mount Everest could be achieved.
4. _____ expeditions helped Hillary and Norgay as a motivation to reach Mount Everest's top.
5. Climbing can be _____ so climbers need to be resourceful.
6. _____ sports like mountain climbing tend to be dangerous.



Let's Practice!

Susan and Mike are mentioning other historical facts about climbing Mount Everest.

Instructions: Complete the conversation below by choosing from the options you are given. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

was credited / was thought / was suggested / was helped / was confirmed

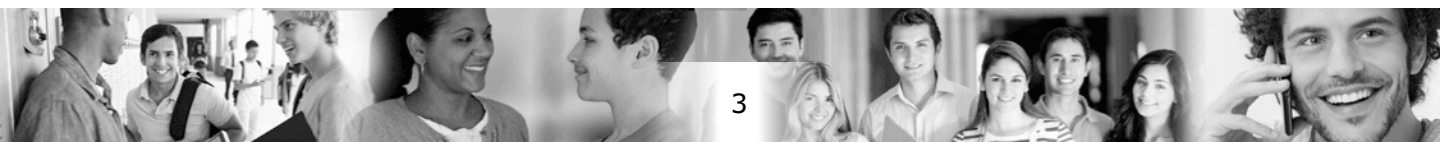
Susan: Did you know that Edmund Hillary _____ by a Nepali Sherpa on his ascent to Mount Everest?

Mike: Yes, I did. His name was Tenzing Norgay. But it _____ that Hillary was the first to set foot at the top.

Susan: I heard that a British team _____ with the first attempt to reach the top of Everest, in 1921.

Mike: I read about it, too. It wasn't successful. Climbing Everest _____ to be too dangerous.

Susan: It still is. Even if it _____ by Clinton Thomas Dent in 1885 that climbing Everest wasn't impossible!





Extension Activity

A book of world records.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research four famous firsts (e.g. First person to climb Everest).
- Fold a piece of paper in half to create four panels.
- Create a headline for each of the famous achievements.
- Write a short paragraph detailing each one.
- Present your "book of records" to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research past accomplishments.

☐ ☐

I write headlines about the past.

☐ ☐

I write a short informational paragraph.

☐ ☐

I share my results with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to achieve** (verb): to succeed in accomplishing a goal
e.g. Clinton Thomas Dent was convinced that it could be achieved.
- feat** (noun): a difficult challenge
e.g. The feat wouldn't be successfully accomplished, however, for another 50-plus years.
- expedition** (noun): an organized trip or adventure
e.g. After several failed expeditions, it was Edmund Hillary who was credited with first reaching the peak.
- sherpa** (noun): a Himalayan mountain guide
e.g. Tenzing Norgay was a Nepali sherpa.
- well-equipped** (adjective): having the appropriate equipment
e.g. Alpinists must be well-equipped.
- gear** (noun): equipment
e.g. They must have the appropriate gear, like ropes and pitons.
- piton** (noun): a spike that is driven into rock to aid in climbing
e.g. The climber drove the piton into the rock.
- to summit** (verb): to reach the top of something
e.g. For thrill-seekers, the rush of summiting outweighs the fear.
- ascent** (noun): the act of climbing or moving towards the top of something
e.g. Each mountain ascent presents new challenges.
- steep** (adjective): a slope that has a sharp angle
e.g. If the mountain is steep and icy, climbers have to take extra precaution.





Learning Points

When to Use -ed and -ing Adjectives

Adjectives which are formed from Infinitive verb forms can have two types of endings: **-ed** and **-ing**.

Adjectives ending in **-ed** describe how someone feels.

Adjectives ending in **-ing** describe how something or someone is, or how a situation makes someone feel.

Adjectives ending in **-ed** can only be used to describe feelings or emotions. They describe how a person feels. They cannot be used to describe an object or situation.

Example: *Sir Edmund Hillary was **fascinated** by the idea of climbing Mt. Everest.*

Adjectives ending in **-ing** can be used either with a person or a situation. They describe the characteristics of a person or a situation. They also describe how a situation makes you feel.

Example: *Sir Edmund Hillary found the idea of climbing Mt. Everest **fascinating**.*

Compare the differences:

- Sir Hillary is **fascinated**. (He feels fascinated.)
- Sir Hillary is **fascinating**. (He is a fascinating person.)
- Climbing Mt. Everest is a **fascinating** challenge. (It causes people to feel fascinated.)

You cannot say *Mt. Everest is fascinated*, since it is not a person.

Examples:

- *It is very easy to become **frustrated** if progress is slow.*
- *Because it is such a **frustrating** activity, climbers must be resourceful.*





Learning Points

Simple Past Passive to Report Events

You can use the **passive voice** when you want to report events that happened in the past in a general way.

Most of spoken English uses active speech. When you use an active sentence to report an event, the subject is the focus of the sentence.

Example:

• *Journalists (subject) **reported** a sharp increase in mountain climbing as a recreational activity (object).*

A **passive sentence** puts the emphasis on the object of the active sentence. When you use a passive sentence to report an event, the object of the active sentence now becomes the subject and focus of the passive sentence.

Example:

• *A sharp increase in mountain climbing as a recreational activity (subject) **was reported by** many journalists (object).*

You can use the **Simple Past passive** form to report events in an impersonal way. The subject is not specific, but general.

Example:

• ***It was said** that mountain climbing **was only practiced by** seasoned explorers, but that has changed over the years.*

You make the passive form of a verb by using tenses of the **be** verb followed by the **past participle**.

You use the structure:

subject + Simple Past passive reporting verb + To-Infinitive (Perfect or Perfect Continuous tense)

Examples:

- *It was thought to be too high, dangerous, and terrifying to climb.*
- *It was later confirmed that the New Zealander had been the first to set foot at the top.*
- *It was a New Zealander and a Nepali sherpa who were credited with first reaching the peak.*
- *For many years, Hillary and Norgay were reported to have summited together.*

